

2026 Marlboro Men's Softball League Bylaws

I. Introduction

1. League Name and Status

The league shall be officially known as the Marlboro Men's Softball League, Inc. (hereinafter referred to as "the League"). The League is organized exclusively for charitable and educational purposes under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, promoting health, fitness, and community recreation through organized amateur athletics, and no part of its net earnings shall benefit any private individual.

II. Administration

1. Commissioner

(a) Governance

The League shall be governed by a League player serving as Commissioner. The Commissioner shall act in the best interests of the League and its members, performing duties outlined herein with assistance from the League Board as needed.

(b) Duties and Responsibilities

The Commissioner shall oversee the overall administration and operation of the League, including but not limited to:

1. Obtaining and maintaining all required field permits.
2. Hiring, assigning, and supervising League umpires.
3. Administering new player applications, membership matters, and eligibility determinations.
4. Organizing and conducting new player tryouts.
5. Appointing and removing Team Captains, as necessary.
6. Advertising and promoting the League.
7. Organizing the annual League awards dinner.
8. Conducting the League draft.
9. Preparing and publishing regular season and playoff schedules.
10. Planning and overseeing All-Star games, including the Mayor's Trophy Game, and other League-sponsored events.

(c) Eligibility, Nomination, and Election

- Any League member with at least five (5) non-consecutive years of participation is eligible to run for Commissioner.
- Interested members must notify the current Commissioner, or a Board member, by October 15th of a given year.
- All candidates shall be announced to the League Members by the Commissioner and Board.
- If multiple candidates seek to run for Commissioner (including the current Commissioner), an election will be held at the annual League Dinner. At that dinner, each candidate may address members in attendance. Members unable to attend may submit votes via email by a Board-established deadline.
- Votes will be counted at the conclusion of the dinner by one board representative and one League member, mutually agreed upon by the candidates. The candidate receiving the majority of votes shall be elected Commissioner.

(d) Term of Office

The Commissioner shall serve a three-year term, remaining in office until a successor is duly elected and assumes responsibilities. As of 2026, the Commissioner is Ronnie Carlin, and he is serving his third year of a three-year term.

(e) Transition

The outgoing Commissioner shall work with the incoming Commissioner to ensure a smooth transition. At the incoming Commissioner's discretion, the outgoing Commissioner may serve on the Board for the following season.

(f) Compensation and Dues

The Commissioner serves in a volunteer capacity and receives no monetary compensation. The annual League registration fee shall be waived for the Commissioner during their term. In addition, the Commissioner may, at his discretion, waive or reduce the annual registration fees of League members who contribute significant time and effort to the operation and success of the League. Such fee waivers are intended as a token of appreciation for voluntary service and recognition of members' contributions, and do not constitute compensation. The determination of

eligibility and the amount of any waiver shall be made solely by the Commissioner, consistent with the League's commitment to fairness and the principles of its nonprofit status.

2. League Board

(a) Composition and Appointment

The Commissioner shall appoint a group of League members, none of whom may currently serve as Team Captain, to assist in the administration and governance of the League. This group shall be known as the Board. Board members may be appointed, removed, or replaced by the Commissioner for good cause, and in the best interests of the League.

As of 2026, the Board consists of the following members:

- Doug Cohen
- Joel Zaretsky
- Edward Fradkin
- Justin Jacoby
- Greg DeLuise

(b) Duties and Authority

The Board, in conjunction with the Commissioner, shall:

1. Implement, modify, and interpret League rules and policies in alignment with the League's best interests.
2. Review, discuss, and vote on matters such as:
 - Player ratings and classifications
 - Player discipline, including suspensions
 - Evaluation of playing fields for playoff eligibility
3. In all matters requiring a vote by the Board, the Commissioner shall have the authority to break any tie. Furthermore, the Commissioner, acting in the best interest of the League, may adjudicate any issue or make any final decision notwithstanding the position of the Board, as all Board members serve at the pleasure of the Commissioner.

(c) Interpretation of Rules; Commissioner Authority

- The Board and Commissioner may interpret any rule or bylaw as necessary.
- The Commissioner retains the right to affirm, modify, or override Board decisions if deemed in the League's best interests.
- Issues not addressed in these bylaws shall be resolved by majority vote of the Board, subject to the Commissioner's authority.

4. Treasurer

The Treasurer shall be responsible for the financial management of the League, including maintaining accurate records of all receipts and expenditures, preparing and presenting financial reports to the Commissioner and Board as requested, and ensuring that all League funds are deposited, disbursed, and accounted for in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. The Treasurer shall also oversee the preparation of any required tax filings and assist with the annual budget, helping to ensure the League's financial integrity and compliance with its nonprofit status.

For the 2026 season, the Treasurer is Joe Mamone.

5. Number of Teams and Divisions

The number of teams participating in the League each year, as well as the formation of any divisions or scheduling structure, shall be determined by the Commissioner based on member interest, available resources, and other relevant considerations. The Commissioner's decisions regarding team numbers, divisions, and scheduling shall be final and made in the best interests of the League.

For the 2026 season, the League will consist of eighteen (18) teams, with three divisions of six teams.

5. Team Captains

(a) Eligibility and Selection

- Each team shall be led by a Team Captain who is a member in good standing and an active player for that season.
- Captains must have participated in the League for at least five (5) non-consecutive seasons.

- The Commissioner selects new Captains, in conjunction with the Board.

(b) Removal of Captains

The performance of Team Captains may be reviewed by the Commissioner and the Board. A Captain may be removed from their position for cause if the Commissioner, with the concurrence of at least sixty percent (60%) of the Board, determines that removal is in the best interest of the League.

Considerations may include:

1. Team performance
2. Player attendance and participation
3. Leadership and management
4. Timely submission of statistics
5. Proper care of team equipment
6. Other relevant factors

(c) Team Equipment and other Responsibilities

Team Captains are responsible for the proper care, maintenance, and storage of all League-provided equipment assigned to their team. Any equipment that is lost, stolen, or damaged while under a Captain's stewardship must be replaced by the Captain with items of equivalent quality and specification. Equipment independently purchased by a Captain or team for use in League play must receive prior approval from the Board. All games shall use the pitching rubber provided by the League in accordance with USSAA rules, and use of any alternative pitching rubber requires prior approval from the Board. The visiting team captain of each game must also ensure that their game is recorded and both captains must also submit weekly statistics in a timely fashion each week. Captains must also advise the board and the opposing captain of all known player absences the night before each game.

III. LEAGUE MEMBERSHIP AND RENEWAL

1. Requirements

(a) The League is open to any male who has turned 18 years of age by September 1 of the applicable season. Proof of age may be requested at the discretion of the Commissioner or Board.

(b) There shall be no residency requirement for League membership.

(c) League fees shall be determined annually by the Commissioner and League accountant based on League expenses and the financial report provided by the Treasurer.

(d) The Commissioner and Board reserve the right to deny any application in the best interest of the League.

(e) Players who participated on a team roster in the previous season are not automatically guaranteed membership for the following year. All applications for participation shall be reviewed annually by the League to determine eligibility and acceptance, based on the best interests of the League. All decisions regarding entry into the league in a given year shall rest solely with the Commissioner and the Board.

2. New Player Admission

All new players seeking to join the League (new players being defined as individuals who have not participated in the League for at least one year) are required to attend a League tryout, unless the Commissioner grants a waiver. New players must also complete a League application and provide the following information:

- Age, height, primary defensive position, arm strength, and batting strength
- Previous playing experience
- Self-assessed comparison to current League players
- Recommended position in the batting lineup
- Referral source
- Any other relevant information that may assist in player evaluation

The Commissioner and League Board shall review all applications to determine eligibility and appropriate placement, ensuring fairness and maintaining the competitive balance of the League.

All players must execute a written waiver acknowledging that they maintain their own health insurance coverage and expressly releasing the League, its officers, directors, Board members, and volunteers from any and all liability for injuries, accidents, or other claims arising from participation in League activities.

3. Annual Tryouts

The League shall conduct annual tryouts for all prospective players, including returning players as deemed necessary by the Commissioner. Tryouts shall consist of infield and outfield practice, batting evaluations, and participation in a rookie showcase game to allow observation of players in a game setting. The Commissioner may, at their discretion, waive tryout attendance for certain players. Tryouts are conducted to evaluate player skill, and maintain competitive balance within the League.

4. Protected Players and Ratings

(a) After tryouts, the Commissioner and Board shall rate Captains and family members (which is defined as a set forth in Article 6 below), designated as protected players, as well as any group picks. The Board may institute draft penalties for teams with multiple protected players to maintain parity.

(b) Protected player ratings are determined by the Commissioner and the Board.

(c) Protected players receive ratings between 1 (top pick) and 13 (last pick), finalized before the draft.

(d) Ratings consider:

- Previous rankings and batting averages
- Board members' knowledge
- Comparisons with similar players
- Positional ability
- Other protected players on that team
- Other relevant factors

(g) Non-protected players who are not part of a group pick do not receive any rating from the Commissioner and Board.

5. Player Draft

(a) The League Draft shall be conducted following the completion of tryouts and the distribution of protected player ratings. The date, time, and location of the Draft shall be determined by the Commissioner. Any accommodations requested by Team Captains shall be reviewed and addressed by the Commissioner in consultation with the Board.

(b) Attendance at the Draft shall be limited to Team Captains unless prior approval is granted by the Commissioner and the Board.

(c) The Draft shall be conducted in a snake-style format, with draft order determined by a random drawing. Notwithstanding the standard format, the thirteenth (13th) round shall commence with Team 18 and conclude with Team 1.

(d) Teams with protected players shall forfeit draft selections in rounds corresponding to the rankings assigned to those protected players.

(e) Player trades may be conducted and must be promptly reported to the Commissioner or a member of the Board. Once the Commissioner and Board have adjourned from the Draft location, no further trades shall be permitted, except in rare and extraordinary circumstances as determined by the Commissioner and the Board to be in the best interests of the League.

6. Group Picks

(a) Family members may elect to enter the Draft as a group and be selected to the same team ("Group Picks"). The determination of what constitutes a "family member" shall be made by the Commissioner.

(b) Group Picks shall be evaluated and ranked in the same manner as protected players. The highest-ranked player within the group shall be selected first, and the remaining player(s) shall be placed into the draft round designated by the Board or, if unavailable, the next highest available round.

(c) The selection of Group Picks consisting of two (2) players must be completed by the twelfth (12th) round of the Draft. Adjustments to this requirement may be made by the Board for Group Picks consisting of more than two players.

7. Replacement of Players

a) In the event a player resigns, withdraws, or becomes unable to continue participation after the completion of the Draft due to injury or other circumstances, the Commissioner, in consultation with the Board, shall determine whether a replacement is necessary. If a replacement is approved, the vacancy shall be filled with a player of comparable skill level, positional ability, and overall impact, as determined by the Commissioner and Board. The round in which the departing player was originally drafted shall not be a determining factor in the selection of a replacement player.

(b) Team Captains are required to promptly notify the Commissioner of any injury, resignation, or uncertainty regarding a player's ability or intent to continue participation in the League. Failure to report such circumstances in a timely manner may be subject to review by the Commissioner and Board.

IV. LEAGUE RULES

1. Rulebook

The league shall follow the USSSA rulebook unless superseded by these league rules.

2. Divisions and Playoff Structure

Same shall be determined by the Commissioner and the board. Addressed below.

3. Current Playoff Structure

a. As of the 2026 seasons, there are 18 teams. The top 14 seeds are guaranteed to make the playoffs with the bottom four seeds playing in a play-in game, at a time and date to be determined by the Commissioner (usually the first Wednesday after Labor Day) with the two winners being the 15 and 16 seeds.

b. As of the 2026 season, there are three divisions of six teams. For the first round only, the three division winners are

guaranteed the top three seeds. Teams are reseeded after the first round based on overall league record.

4. Tiebreakers for Playoff Seeding

Two-team tie:

1. Head-to-head record
2. Division record, if both teams are in the same division. If not, strength of schedule of the games each team won (which will be calculated by adding up the records of the teams that each team beat to determine who had the tougher schedule). The team with a higher opponent winning percentage will be the higher seed.
3. Draw numbers out of a hat

Three-team tie (or more):

1. Combined head-to-head record among the three teams. After first winner is established, go through same analysis with remaining teams.
2. Division record, if all teams are in the same division. If not, strength of schedule of the games each team won (which will be calculated by adding up the records of the teams that each team beat to determine who had the tougher schedule).
3. Draw number out of a hat.

5. Playoff Fields

- a. To be determined by the Commissioner and the Board based on availability and the best interests of the league.
- b. Second round and beyond: The selection of fields may be limited by the Commissioner and the Board so only the league's best fields are in play.
- c. If a series is tied 1-1, Game 3 may be moved based on field availability and conditions, at the discretion of the Board and Commissioner.

6. Choice of Playoff Field

a. Higher seeded team always gets field choice (to the extent a field choice exists)

7. Official Games

a. Whether a game that has already started should be called due to rain is in the sole discretion of the umpire.

b. Additional Rules regarding Official Games are addressed below.

8. Pre-Game Meeting

a. Umpires shall meet with both team captains prior to the game to review field-specific ground rules and other points of interest.

b. Captains must inform the umpire which player is the designated walk guy (addressed below).

c. All players bat the entire game. Late arrivals can bat anywhere in the order unless the leadoff hitter has batted for a second time (in other words, the lineup has flipped). Once that occurs, late arrivals must go to the end of the lineup. Captains must advise their opposing captain and the umpire if a player is going to leave a game early (for non-emergent reasons). Failure to do so will result in an out in the lineup for that player's at bats. In addition, ejected players shall count as outs when their spot comes up.

9. Pitching

a. Pitch arc must be between 6 and 12 feet. Illegal pitches are automatic balls, but the batter may swing. Umpires should announce illegal pitches as soon as possible. Mats are placed where home plate is usually laid down. If a pitch is between six and twelve feet and hits the mat, it is a strike. Otherwise, it is a ball.

b. Excessive-speed pitches result in an automatic walk. A second offense removes the pitcher from pitching, but not from the game.

10. The Count

- a. Hitters start with a 1-1 count. Four balls = walk.
- b. Three strikes = out (called or swung).
- c. After two strikes, only one additional foul is allowed; a second foul after two strikes is a strikeout.
- d. Any tipped foul caught by the catcher is an out, with no height restriction, regardless of the count.

11. Softballs

- a. Two new balls per game. Each captain supplies one. Balls are inserted at the top and bottom of the first inning.
- b. Only DeBeer Clincher softballs are approved.

12. Base Running - Slide or Avoid

- a. Runners must slide or avoid defensive players attempting a play. Non-incidental contact results in an out and a dead ball, at the discretion of the umpire. Other runners return to previous base. Ejections for violations are at the umpire's discretion and subject to Board review

13. Player Behavior

- a. Ejections result in a presumption of a minimum one-game suspension. However, that presumption can be overcome in the board's discretion after investigating the issue that led to the ejection. The board may also extend the suspension to two games, or more, based on severity.
- b. Foul language before, during, or after games is prohibited. Umpires may eject violators.
- c. Players are expected to participate for the entire season. Excessive absences, even for injury, may result in being removed from the league. Any player who has missed six games out of the first eleven games may be removed from the league, depending on circumstances and in the board's discretion.

14. Disputed Calls

a. Only team captains may address umpires regarding calls. Captains may not argue balls and strikes or discretionary plays, but may clarify league rules.

15. Rainouts

a. A rain committee shall check fields after inclement weather. The Commissioner, in conjunction with the rain committee, shall decide if games must be cancelled.

16. Rescheduling

a. Any game that is rained out, or must be made up for any reason, shall be rescheduled by the board. The rescheduled date shall be firm unless the two captains involved, within one week of the rescheduling, notify the board of an agreed-upon different date that is approved by the board.

17. Lights

a. Any game that ends due to the lights going out shall be deemed official (provided that the losing team has batting five full times - if they have not, the game is restarted). The team that was ahead at the last completed inning shall be the winner. Tie games shall resume.

18. Start Times

a. Start times on Sunday morning may be anywhere from 8:00 a.m. until 12:00 p.m.

b. Wednesday night games shall start at 8:15 p.m. unless a different time is scheduled by the Commissioner and Board.

19. Equipment

- a. Bats must meet Amateur Softball Association (now USA) standards. Illegal bats result in ejection and possible suspension. If it is determined that an illegal bat was used during an at-bat, the batter is out.
- b. Any fielding glove may be used at any position, including first basemen gloves.
- c. Metal spikes are prohibited.

OTHER RULES

- 20. Foul ball strikeouts are dead balls. Runners may not advance/tag-up.
- 21. Defensive substitutions are allowed at anytime.
- 22. Pinch-running: one-time per player, per game. Base runner may pinch run for another runner on base.
- 23. Intentional walks are verbal.
- 24. Pitching mound: 48 feet; bases: 60 feet apart.
- 25. No leading off base; runners may leave once the ball crosses home plate or is contacted.
- 26. Winning captain emails score to the website administrator.
- 27. Double first base: runners touch outside; defensive players touch inside. However, runners may touch the inside base to avoid a collision.
- 28. Umpires may waive home plate contact if unsafe.
- 29. Minimum of eight players to start.
- 30. If a team is reduced to 7 players it shall be a forfeit.
- 31. Every player must play at least three defensive innings.

32. Ejected players must leave the field and park immediately; noncompliance may result in forfeit and further suspension. An ejected player is an out in the lineup for that particular game when his spot comes up.

33. Mercy rule for both regular season and playoffs: 15-run lead after the losing team has batted seven times.

34. Bench selection: Regular season - home team chooses. Playoffs - higher seed chooses.

35. During the regular season, if a team is missing two players that were drafted 11, 12, or 13 (C player), the C player that is present shall bat twice.

36. Replacement players can be granted at any time prior to the play-offs beginning (which includes the play-in game).

37. Balls hit on a fly into the trees at East Francis are an automatic home run. If not hit on a fly into the trees, it is "all you can get."

38. Captains of the All-Star game shall be the two captains with the best records after 11 games. If three or more captains have the same record, the tiebreaker will be based on head to head and then go into the playoff tiebreaker rules.

39. Mayor's Trophy Game - Captains shall be the championship captain from the prior year. Team will be selected by the Captain, in conjunction with the Commissioner and the Board.

40. In the playoffs, team must always bat 13 players. If a player is missing, the person who was drafted behind that player shall bat twice. If your 1st rounder is missing your 2nd rounder will bat twice, and so on. If two players are missing that were drafted back-to-back, such as a 7 and 8, the one-up/one-down rule shall apply and the team's 6 and 9 shall bat twice. If a B rated player (drafted 8-10) is ever batting for a C rated player (drafted 11-13), that B rated player must lead off. An example of this is if a team is missing their 12 and 13, their 10 (who is a B) and their 11 would bat twice. Any player who bats twice

may also run twice, but they do not have to play six innings in the field. See below for Regular Season Missing Player Rule

41. Captains are required to report missing players via text to the Board and other captain by the night before a playoff game.

42. Bases are set at 60 feet.

43. Pitcher's rubber is set at 48 feet.

44. One Ball and One Strike count with one additional foul ball allowed after two strikes.

45. Batter who hits a foul ball with two strikes and no free foul remaining, whether caught or dropped, is a dead ball out. Runners may not advance.

46. Batter/Runner must touch the outside runner's base at first base. Exception: Runner may touch the fielder's inside base to avoid a collision or to round first base on a hit to the outfield.

47. Batter/Runner is not permitted to slide into first base. If they do, the batter is out, and all runners may advance at their own risk.

48. Pitchers must release the pitch from the pitching rubber with at least one foot on the rubber.

49.. Pitches must reach a height of no less than 6 feet and no higher than 12 feet.

50. Pitchers are not permitted to throw with excessive speed, as determined by the umpire.

51. All pitches must have a discernible arc. Pitcher's elbow must be in a locked position. Sidearm deliveries are not permitted.

52. Once the batter is in the batter's box, the pitcher may deliver the pitch.

53. Umpires shall call a ball on all illegal flat, high, or fast pitches early, verbally, before the pitch arrives at the plate.

54. Every eligible player in attendance who is physically able to play must be in the batting order and must play a minimum of three defensive innings.

55. Every player in the lineup may be used as a courtesy runner once per game. If there are two runners on base, both may be used, including switching places. Both captains are responsible for tracking all pinch runners.

56. Runners may vacate their bases once the pitched ball hits the ground or the batter makes contact with the ball.

57. Games are nine innings with a 15-run mercy rule after the losing team has batted seven times. Teams may concede at their discretion at any point.

58. Any pitch that hits the mat and meets all other qualifications is declared a strike.

59. Any player injured during the game may vacate, subject to the rules outlined herein.

60. Players aware before the start of a game that they must leave early must notify the umpire and opposing manager; otherwise, an out will be declared the next time their spot comes up in the order. Exceptions: emergencies. Late-arriving players shall bat at the end of the lineup unless their spot is still available. Spots of early-leaving players are skipped without penalty (provided the requisite notice was given).

61. Players ejected from a game forfeit all future at-bats; their spot in the order is counted as an out each time. Further discipline may follow.

62. League rules supersede USSSA rules. USSSA rules apply when necessary.

63. First and third base coaches may not have a fielder's glove on their hands; gloves must be behind their backs, tucked into pants, or on the ground.

64. Umpires are in charge of the game, including all weather-related decisions, once they arrive.

65. Only the manager may address a call with the umpire. It is their responsibility to ensure other players do not address the umpire.

66. The home team's book is official. Any scoring disagreements should be addressed with the umpire promptly.

67. Each team will declare a walk hitter. Each team may designate one player per game as a Walk Hitter. The designation must be declared to the opposing captain and the umpire before the start of the game.

- The Walk Hitter may be walked, without penalty, no more than two (2) times per game.
- A third walk (and any thereafter) shall result in the batter being awarded two bases.
- If the Walk Hitter receives a strike during the at-bat, that walk does not count toward the two-walk limit.
- Both captains are responsible for tracking the Walk Hitter count.
- If a two base penalty is awarded with a runner on second, that runner only goes to third. Men already on base only move up as forced.

68. Only ASA/USA-approved bats are allowed. Illegal bats are removed from play, and the player may face penalties. A batter will be declared out if he uses an illegal bat and it is brought to the umpire's attention prior to the next pitch being thrown.

69. All runners must slide or avoid fielders at each base except first base.

70. Plays at the plate: Both runner and catcher may touch the mat on a force out. Runners must take all necessary steps to avoid contact.

71. Catchers must allow a running lane to the plate.

71. Runners who do not slide and interfere with the catcher's play are out due to offensive interference. Runners who do not slide or veer off on double play attempts at second base will be out as will the runner to first, at the umpire's discretion.

72. Catchers who block the plate without allowing a running lane result in obstruction; the runner is safe.

73. Fielders may not decoy the runner into sliding by placing their gloves down; violations may result in ejection.

74. Fielders and runners are prohibited from yelling to confuse opponents; umpires may call penalties.
75. Players may be substituted defensively at any time, provided all players play at least three full innings on defense.
76. Intentional walks may be declared verbally.
77. Home team selects the bench during the regular season. During playoffs, the higher seed selects the bench.
78. Any glove may be used at any position.
79. All games are nine innings. Regular-season games are official after the losing team has batted five times. Games not meeting this requirement shall be restarted.
80. Playoff games must be finished to completion. Games called after reaching official status resume where they left off. Otherwise, they are restarted. Captains may not alter this rule.
81. Umpire decisions are final. Games may not be protested.
82. Umpires may advise players not to touch home plate if the area is wet or dangerous.
83. Metal spikes are prohibited.
84. Any bat deemed illegal or banned by ASA/USA is banned by the League.
85. A pitching rubber must be used.
86. A game requires at least eight players to start. Teams unable to field eight within 15 minutes of the game start time shall forfeit. If reduced to seven during play, the team forfeits.
87. Any batted ball over the third-tier fence in right field that lands in the net is a home run. Balls hitting the top pole and bouncing into the net are also home runs if, in the umpire's discretion, they would have cleared the fence.

V. MISSING PLAYER RULES

a. During the Regular season - If two of three C-players (defined as players who were drafted in rounds 11-13) are missing, the remaining C players bats twice (but may only pinch-run once). If all three C-players are out, the "10" bats twice (may pinch-run once). The player batting twice is not required to play six defensive innings and cannot pinch-run twice.

* Exception: If a team plays with 8 players, no player has to bat twice.

b. New Regular Season Missing Player Rule effective for the 2026 season

1. When this rule applies

- This rule applies only when a team has 10 players present and playing.
- Teams that have ten players must always bat a minimum of 11 spots in the lineup.

2. Lineups not affected

- No changes for teams with:
 - 8, 9, 11, 12, or 13 players
- Exception:
 - The C Player Rule now applies to lineups of 9

3. How to create the 11th batter

If a team has 10 players, they must add an 11th batting spot using one of the following:

A. If the C Player Rule Applies

- The C Player becomes the 11th batter

B. If No C Player Applies

1. Identify the 3 missing draft positions
2. Calculate their average draft position (mean)
3. Round UP to the next whole number
4. That draft slot becomes the player who bats twice

- If that player is not present:
 - Move to the next lower-rated available player until one is found
- The selected player:
 - Bats twice in the lineup
 - Keeps both spots for the entire game regardless of late arrivals
- Examples
 - Example 1
 Players out: 3, 6, 8
 Total = 17 → Average = 5.67 → Round UP → 6
 If 6 is out → next available player → 7 bats twice
 - Example 2
 Players out: 1, 2, 13
 Total = 16 → Average = 5.33 → Round UP → 6
 6 is present → 6 bats twice

4. "What If" Scenarios

A. Late Arrival

- A player arriving after the game starts, and after a player has already batted twice, shall be:
 - Added to the end of the lineup (assuming their team has gone through the entire lineup at least once)
 - Does not change who is batting twice

B. Injury to the Double Batter

- If the player batting twice gets injured or has to leave early, and the team drops to be below ten players:
 - The 11-batter rule no longer applies
 - Standard short-handed rules apply

C. Defensive Play and Pinch Running

- A player batting twice:
 - Does not have to play six innings in the field
 - May not pinch run twice per game

D. Team starts with 11 and is reduced to 10 during the game

- The bat 11 rule would immediately become effective once a team is down to ten players
- Using the above, the player batting twice, as determined using subsection V(3) above, would take the spot in the line-up of the person he is replacing (i.e. the 11th man who left and/or was injured)

c. During the Playoffs - Teams must always bat 13. If a team is missing a player, the next-rated player bats twice and plays 6 minimum defensive innings. Example: If player 4 is missing, player 5 bats twice. That player may also pinch-run twice. If a "B" player (drafted 8-10) is batting for a "C" player (drafted 11-13), the B-player must also bat leadoff. One up/one down rule: If back-to-back drafted players are missing, the players immediately before and after bat twice.

VI. PLAYOFF SEEDING AND TIEBREAKERS

- Division winners will receive top seeds according to their record. For 2026, there are three divisions and the three division winners will be seeded 1-3 with reseeding taking place after the first round.
- Non-division winners are seeded according to overall record.
- Teams are reseeded after the first round based on overall league record.
- Tie-breakers: Addressed above
- Seeds 15-18 play a play-in game on the Wednesday after Labor Day weekend
- Seed matchups: #1 seed plays lowest seed, #2 seed plays second-lowest seed, and so on.

VII. MISCELLANEOUS

Start times for all Sunday morning games may be anywhere from 8:00 a.m. until 12:00 p.m. and times may change the morning of a game depending on weather and field availability.

Any issue that arises that is not covered by the within rules, shall be addressed by the Commissioner and the Board based on the best interests of the league.